D.J. PARIS

A $650 LINE ITEM IS NOW A LAWSUIT.

A buyer sued his agent's brokerage over a fee nobody could explain.

D.J. Paris
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A PENNSYLVANIA BUYER IS SUING KELLER WILLIAMS ELITE OVER A $650 BROKER FEE WITH NO NAMED SERVICE BEHIND IT.

The brokerage had already collected $14,700 in commission from the seller.

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THE FEE WASN'T THE PROBLEM. THE SILENCE WAS.

The lawsuit, filed in Lancaster County's Court of Common Pleas, says the $650 fee showed up on the settlement statement with no description of what it actually paid for. His attorney calls it a textbook junk fee and argues the seller's $14,700 commission already covered the brokerage's work twice over. He's asking for $50,000 and a ruling that bars the fee from being charged again without disclosing what it covers. This isn't a one-off: the CFPB opened a formal inquiry into real estate junk fees back in 2024, so regulators are already primed to look for exactly this line item.

DO THIS BEFORE YOUR NEXT CLOSING:

1 **Name every fee on the settlement statement in plain English.**

"Transaction coordination, $450" survives a second read. "Administrative fee, $450" doesn't.

2 **Ask yourself if you could explain the fee to the client's face.**

If the honest answer is "that's just what we charge," change the fee or the explanation.

3 **Put the explanation in writing before the client has to ask a lawyer for one.**

A line item nobody can explain is the one a judge reads first.

THE TAKEAWAY

HERE'S WHAT YOU DO NOW.

Pull your own fee schedule today and read every line the way a client's attorney would.

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